

Note:- The Raspberry Pi Zero deserves a special mention. Launched in November 2015 at the jaw dropping price of 5\$, it is slightly more capable than the 35\$ Model B from 2012 at the price of a pizza. Even though it has the same single core CPU, clock speed has been bumped up to 1GHz. As usual, you might need to buy the list of accessories mentioned above to set it up.

The Beagle from Texas

Announced in October 2011 by BeagleBoard.org, an open source hardware company that is a part of Texas Instruments' Design Network, Beaglebone is another alternative in the credit-card sized computer market that supports Ubuntu and Android 4.0. A more barebones version of the company's other offerings Beagleboard and Beagleboard-xM, this chip packs a 720MHz ARM processor, 256MB DDR2 RAM, two-46 pin expansion connectors and on chip Ethernet with microSD slot. Initially launched at 89\$ in the US, currently Indian ecommerce websites are listing it around 4500INR. As with all other open source boards, a lot of official and unofficial variants are present and all you need to do is find the right store.



The Beaglebone black, a snazzier upgrade to the Beaglebone

The Beaglebone Black is a better-specification model of the Beaglebone. With 512MB RAM and clock speed at 1GHz this one is for more resource intensive applications. The combination of the Pi's power with Arduino's interfacing capabilities makes this a strong contender in the market. Also due to a vast community and the resource backing of Texas instruments Beaglebone is now a third alternative preferred by many.

So which one would you choose?

The Big Question - The Big Three

With the number of alternatives available, with the likes of Arduino, Raspberry Pi, and Beaglebone, it might be daunting for a beginning Maker to decide which one is best suited for his or her DIY adventure. Each of the big